

using a browser at <http://sketchup.google.com/3dwarehouse>, or by clicking on Google > Get Models in SketchUp. Click on a model to download it to your computer, view it directly in SketchUp, or download it as a .kmz file that can be viewed in Google Earth.

After downloading a model to SketchUp, you can click the “Place Model” option under the Google menu to export and view the model in Google Earth. Use the tilt and navigation controls to adjust the viewing angle of the model.

Note that the models imported from SketchUp and downloaded from 3D Warehouse are stored in the Temporary folder in the Places panel. If you wish to permanently retain these items, you will need to save them to your My Places folder. See Chapter 8 for details.



The Statue of Liberty from the 3D warehouse, at her rightful place in Google Earth

You can also create a model in SketchUp, save it, and add it to Google Earth. To do this:

- First create and save your model, start SketchUp, and then start Google Earth. Starting Google Earth (GE) first may cause SketchUp to crawl.
- Next, turn on the Terrain layer in GE and set the **Rendering > Elevation Exaggeration** to 1, and the Detail Area to Medium or Large in the menu settings: **Tools > Options > View**.
- In Windows, set GE to DirectX mode (**Start > Programs > Google Earth > Set Google Earth to Direct X mode**). You can leave it as OpenGL if that setting is faster and if the SketchUp menu command **Google > Get Current View** works without problems.

- In GE, fly to the location you wish to place the model on, looking straight down.
- In SketchUp, use the **Get Current View** command to import a snapshot of the terrain.
- Place your model over the terrain and ensure that it fits snugly into any slope and elevation in the terrain. For example, you might need to add support pillars to a building model if it is on sloped terrain. Use the **Google > Toggle Terrain** menu command to view your model in a 3D terrain. Use the **Move/Copy** tool if required to position the model correctly.
- Next, use the orbit tool to rotate the model till you are looking down directly at it.
- Select the **Google > Place Model** menu command to place the model where you took the terrain snapshot.
- If you are satisfied with the results and want to share it with others, consider uploading it to the 3D Warehouse. Select **Google > Share Model** from SketchUp and follow the instructions to upload your model to the 3D Warehouse.

For more detailed instructions on troubleshooting problems with using SketchUp and Google Earth, go to <http://sketchup.google.com/support/bin/topic.py?topic=8539> or <http://snipurl.com/googsketch3>.